

DRIFT & DWELLS

T H E
VALLEY

guest guide

OFF GRID • 1,500 M • RHODOPE MOUNTAINS • ОБЩИНА БЕЛИЦА

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READ THIS
PAGE ONLY

If you read nothing else in this guide,
read this. Everything after it is detail.

Three things about this place that are not like a hotel.

2.5^{km}

THE LAST STRETCH

From the Chereshevo parking to the cabins. Walk it in about 45 minutes, or take a €20 transfer arranged in advance. No private car goes past the parking.

No shops
past Bansko

STOCK UP FIRST

There are no supermarkets or pharmacies after Bansko or Razlog. Honey, cheese, milk and eggs can be bought in the villages, in cash.

Solar power,
and it is
finite

USE IT LIGHTLY

Fine for lights, phones and laptops. Not for electric heaters or other high-power devices brought from home.

IN YOUR FIRST HOUR

- Find the key, the fire extinguisher, the wood store and the waste point
- Learn the stove, and how to turn hot water on and off
- Charge everything while there is still daylight
- Walk the paths once in daylight, and show children the limits

THE FOUR HOUSE RULES

- Nothing but water down the drains. No oils, paint or chemicals
- Never leave a stove door open unattended. Ashes into the container provided
- Supervise children near the creek, the fire and the slopes
- Keep pets under control, away from wildlife and farm animals

ARRIVAL, TRANSFERS, OR ANYTHING UNCLEAR

Full directions are in the How to Arrive guide. To arrange a €20 transfer, message us in your booking chat, or:

+359 87 634 2540

jose@driftdwells.com

Transfers are arranged in advance and subject to availability.

01

BEFORE YOU LEAVE TOWN

Bansko and Razlog are the last places to buy anything.

There are no supermarkets or pharmacies after Bansko or Razlog.

Once you have parked, anything forgotten costs you the drive down and the 2.5 km back up. It is worth ten extra minutes in the supermarket.

BUY BEFORE YOU CLIMB

- Fill the fuel tank
- Food for all your main meals
- Snacks, water, drinks, coffee and tea
- Medicines, baby items, anything specific you need
- Cash, in small notes

WORTH BUYING UP HERE

Honey, milk, butter, cheese, and sometimes meat and eggs, direct from the villages. Cash only. There are no card machines and no cash points.



02

POWER, WATER, HEAT

You do not need special skills to stay here. You do need to understand three things.

Electricity

Solar panels and batteries. Enough for lights, charging phones and laptops, and normal everyday use. Turn lights off when you leave a room, avoid running several heavy appliances at once, and expect lower levels after days of cloud. If we mention batteries are low, read it as a request to go easy for a while.

Water

Collected from the mountain, returned to local systems. Use it normally, keep showers reasonable, and never pour oils, paint, harsh chemicals or rubbish into sinks or toilets. Whatever goes down the drain, someone eventually has to deal with.

Heat and hot water

A wood stove or fireplace for warmth, and a gas or hybrid system for hot water. On the first day, learn the air vents and the fuel, and how to turn the hot water on and off correctly.

STOVE AND GAS SAFETY

- Do not leave fire or stove doors open unattended
- Do not place items directly on hot metal surfaces
- Dispose of ashes only into the container provided

If something feels wrong

If you smell gas, or a system behaves in a way you do not expect, stop using it and contact us. Do not work around it.



03

TERRAIN, CHILDREN, PETS

A safe piece of wild land with cabins on it. Not a fenced resort.

The environment here is real, not padded.

Move slowly, carry a light after dark, and assume nothing has been fenced off for you.

TERRAIN

Uneven ground, slopes and roots, natural steps and rocks, and paths that can be muddy or slippery. Use a light at night.

CHILDREN

Keep them away from stoves, fires and hot surfaces. Agree where they can walk alone and where they need an adult. Near the creek, always supervise.

PETS

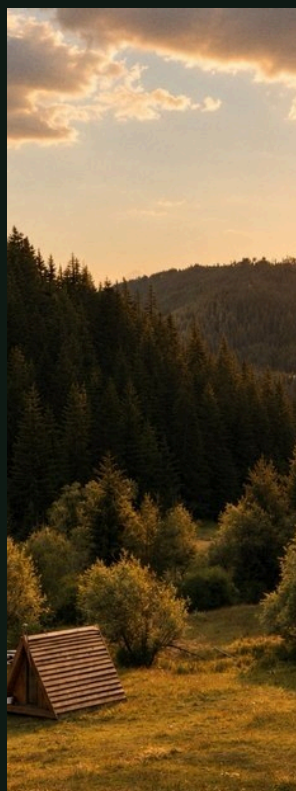
If your unit allows pets, keep them under control, do not let them chase wildlife or farm animals, and clean up after them.



04

ON THE LAND

What is here, and the three places worth going out of your way for.



A-FRAME CABINS



FIRE EVENINGS



THE STONE HOUSE

THE LAYOUT

- A restored 400-year-old stone house
- A-frame cabins with views and privacy
- A luxury-style cabin tucked into the woods
- Shared outdoor areas: fire pit, seating, outdoor dining
- Paths towards the creek and the viewpoints

On your first full day, walk the land slowly and notice how it is put together.

USE THESE THREE

Viewpoints and swings

Go at sunrise or sunset. Stay longer than feels necessary. Leave your phone in your pocket for the first ten minutes.

The creek

Cold, clean water. Good for tired feet, or full dips in warmer months. Rocks can be slippery.

The night sky

On clear nights, turn off the exterior lights, let your eyes adjust for 10 to 15 minutes, and look up.

05

DAYS OUT
FROM HERE

Availability depends on season, weather and booking. Ask us and we will match a route to the conditions.

ATVs

Real tracks, not circles in a field. Forest routes, ridges and viewpoints. Short introduction rides, or half-day and full-day trips.

Stay on the tracks, slow down near people, houses and animals, and respect fences and farmland.

Horse riding

Short rides for beginners, half-day rides with views and breaks, and longer routes linking several villages.

Be honest about your riding experience. Routes are adapted to your level.

Hiking

Short local loops of one to two hours from your cabin, longer loops for experienced walkers, and combined jeep and hike days where you are dropped at a ridge and picked up elsewhere.

The two sides

Chereshovo gives you shorter access back to Razlog and Bansko, village life, and easier walks. Ortsevo gives you high plateau, dramatic panoramas, and cloud-inversion days when it feels like you are above an ocean of mist.

For any hike. Start earlier than you think you need. Carry water, an extra layer and a charged phone. Tell someone at The Valley roughly where you are going and when you plan to be back.

Ask us anything.
We would rather answer
than have you guess.

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Parking 41.949939, 23.715978 · The Valley 41.9551759, 23.738895

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